POLICY | MARKETING

Guaranteed Paddy Purchase Price and the Paddy Marketing Board

How the state buys paddy at a guaranteed price, the 2026 Yala rates, and the quality standards paddy must meet.

Document AV-POL-06 | Category: policy | Status as found on 3 October 2026
Teaching edition for the STEMLink AI Engineer Bootcamp, compiled from official Sri Lankan sources (Department of Agriculture and RRDI web pages, Agricultural and Agrarian Insurance Board, Cabinet decisions as reported), accessed 3 October 2026. Sources are listed in the corpus README, not in this document.

1. The scheme

Each season the government announces guaranteed prices at which the Paddy Marketing Board (PMB) buys paddy from farmers. Purchased stocks go to the government's strategic paddy reserve. The Department of Agrarian Development oversees the purchasing. Small and medium scale buyers may also purchase at the guaranteed prices. Opening state purchasing is intended to set a benchmark that private buyers must meet.

2. 2026 Yala season rates

Table 1. Guaranteed purchase prices, 2026 Yala season (announced 30 June 2026)

Nadu: Rs. 120 per kg
Samba: Rs. 130 per kg
Keeri Samba: Rs. 140 per kg

Purchasing began on 13 July 2026, with the first centre at Uhana in Ampara district, through 143 storage locations across the island.

For comparison, the 2025 Yala guaranteed prices were Rs. 120 for Nadu, Rs. 125 for Samba and Rs. 132 for Keeri Samba per kilogram.

3. Quality standards

- Only dry paddy is purchased.
- Moisture content of 14 percent or less.
- Less than 9 percent immature grains.
- Colour and overall quality are assessed before purchase.

4. 2026/27 Maha season

Guaranteed prices for the 2026/27 Maha harvest had not been announced as of 3 October 2026. Farmer organisations have publicly disputed the 2026 Yala prices as below the cost of production.